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Harvard hit with \$2b funding freeze

Action comes after university defied Trump's demands

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

Hours after Harvard University defied the Trump administration's attempt to force policy changes and federal oversight of the school's affairs, the government hit back hard Monday night, announcing a freeze of

more than \$2 billion in federal funding tied to Harvard.

"Harvard's statement today reinforces the troubling entitlement mindset that is endemic in our nation's most prestigious universities and colleges — that federal investment does not come with the responsibility to

uphold civil rights laws," the Trump administration's anti-semitism task force said in a press release announcing the funding freeze.

Earlier Monday, the university had said it would not acquiesce to a list of extraordinary demands sent to the school's lead-

ers on Friday night. The demands included abolishing diversity programs, turning over admissions and hiring data to the federal government, commissioning external audits of specific academic programs the administration accused of anti-semitism, and alerting federal authorities whenever a foreign student violated campus rules.

The task force said Harvard must accept those demands to maintain its "financial relationship with the federal government."

In an open letter Monday afternoon, Harvard president Alan Garber was defiant. "No government — regardless of which party is in power — should dictate

'The University will not surrender its independence or relinquish its constitutional rights.'

ALAN GARBER, *Harvard president*

HARVARD, Page A5

ACADEMIC INSTITUTIONS UNDER THREAT:

- **Harvard University**, facing demands from the federal government, has \$9 billion at stake.
- **Cornell University** is in line for a cut of at least \$1 billion.
- **Brown University** stands to lose \$510 million.
- **Columbia University** is hoping to regain about \$400 million in canceled grants and contracts after it bowed to Trump administration demands.
- **Princeton University** could lose \$210 million in grants.



SUZANNE KREITER/GLOBE STAFF

Ray Trombley, a Vietnam vet now dying of liver cancer, says Veterans Affairs services have been essential to paying for his health care.

VA FACES BIG CUTS AS NEED FOR CARE RISES

By Kay Lazar
GLOBE STAFF

Ray Trombley ran away from home when he was 14. At 16, he won a court's blessing to live on his own and enlisted in the Air Force, landing in Vietnam as the war was winding down in 1973.

In the decades since, he graduated college, raised three children, supervised large construction projects, and settled in Western Massachusetts.

Today, at 68, Trombley is dying of liver cancer. The Veterans Affairs department says the diagnosis is not linked to his military service but to decades of drinking before Trombley found sobriety eight years ago. Still, his

Internal documents suggest terminating thousands of staffers won't fix agency's woes

250th celebrations dampened

Festivities being planned to mark the nation's 250th anniversary next year are at risk of being significantly scaled back because of funding cuts under the Trump administration. **A5.**

considerable health care bills are covered by the VA. He also receives a small monthly veteran's disability check for a constant "screeching" sound in his ears, the aftermath of his Air Force job loading cargo planes.

Trombley is among a rapidly rising percentage of vets receiving such compensation from the VA, a proud institution now sagging under the sheer volume of health care, disability benefits, and other services its sprawling system provides to at least 9 million vets. Many, like Trombley, are living with more disabilities than ever before.

With over 470,000 staffers, the government's second-largest workforce, the VA

VETERANS, Page A6

Tufts student case raises legal dilemma

Federal judge sees risk of 'constitutional crisis'

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio, and Travis Andersen
GLOBE STAFF
and Ava Berger
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

BURLINGTON, Vt. — A federal judge weighing the case of Rümeysa Öztürk, the Tufts graduate student who was taken into custody by immigration enforcement agents last month in Somerville and whisked off to a detention facility in Louisiana, questioned whether Öztürk's rights were violated and raised the specter of a "constitutional crisis" if he were to order Öztürk's release.

"What is really fundamentally a question for me is, 'what if she is right?'" Judge William K. Sessions III asked from the bench during a hearing in federal court here Monday morning. "What if there was a constitutional violation in her arrest?"

Öztürk, a Turkish national and Fulbright

HEARING, Page A7

►El Salvador's leader says he won't release wrongfully deported man. **A2.**

US to put new levies on chip, drug imports

By Ana Swanson and Tony Romm
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration took steps Monday that appear likely to result in new tariffs on semiconductors and pharmaceutical products, adding to the levies President Trump has put on imports globally.

Federal notices put online Monday afternoon said the administration had initiated national security investigations into imports of chips and pharmaceuticals. Trump has suggested that those investigations could result in tariffs.

The investigations will also cover the machinery used to make semiconductors, prod-

TARIFFS, Page A6

Rockport car owners suffer beak anxiety

Woodpecker on rampage breaking side view mirrors

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

ROCKPORT — The culprit is a bird. Or birds. Or perhaps it's the start of the great bird apocalypse of 2025, and history will record that it started in the Squam Hill neighborhood of this North Shore town.

For what is happening is so comically absurd that it feels like the beginning of a bad movie. Day after day, a pileated woodpecker has been smashing the side view mirrors on cars

throughout the neighborhood. A rough count is about 20 mirrors, based on interviews with neighbors, but it's hard to keep up because it's still happening.

In one instance, the woodpecker cracked the windshield of a pickup truck while the driver was sitting inside.

"I was cleaning it, wiping off the seats and the dash, and I thought my girlfriend was knocking on the window," said Mike Foster, who lives on Riellys Lane. "But I looked up, and he was just smashing his head into the windshield."

He said it was both shocking and kind of funny, until he considered what a pain it would be

PILEATED, Page A10



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF



JANELLE FAVALORO

Ben Favaloro of Rockport is reflected in the cracked mirror from his truck. It is one of about 20 smashed by a pileated woodpecker (left) over the last several weeks in the town's Squam Hill neighborhood.



Lightning it up

Tuesday: Thunderstorm. High 59-64, low 39-44.
Wednesday: Mostly cloudy. High 48-53, low 37-42.
Sunrise: 6:03. Sunset: 7:26.
Obituaries, **C8-9.**
Comics and Weather, **D5-6.**

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Family and colleagues are remembering the two long-time Boston surgeons and their Weston family killed in a plane crash in upstate New York on Saturday. **B1.**

Meet the mild-mannered engineer who's pushing Cambridge to finally tackle its housing crisis. Since being elected city councilor in 2021, Burhan Azeem has helped write and pass some of the broadest reforms Massachusetts has seen in years, including a six-story multifamily allowance. **D1.**

Russia claimed its deadly missile attack on Ukraine's Sumy on Sunday that killed and wounded scores including children had targeted a gathering of Ukrainian troops, while European leaders condemned the attack as a war crime. **A3.**